



2025

USA Consumer Expectations of Mobile App Security



INTRODUCTION

AI-Based Threats Take Center Stage

In Appdome's 5th Annual Survey of Consumer Expectations for Mobile App Security, one theme dominates: the rise of AI-driven threats. In the US, consumers are embracing the potential of AI while remaining acutely aware of its risks. 89.4% of US consumers believe that mobile apps must protect against deepfakes, bots, impersonation, and account takeovers; yet only 10.6% feel very confident that these protections are in place. This confidence gap reveals a significant disparity between expectations and delivery.

In this year's survey, 63.7% of US consumers fear synthetic fraud (fraud and identity theft from mobile apps), making it the top concern in 2025. Breaking this down, identity theft (44.7%) and fraudulent transactions (19%) are the leading triggers for abandonment, reinforcing the need for mobile brands to consider stronger customer identity protections.

Ultimately, mobile app protection remains the tipping point for loyalty. More than 54% of US consumers have abandoned mobile apps due to security concerns, while 91.3% would actively recommend mobile apps that offer them protection. Security is no longer just a feature; it is the dividing line between churn and advocacy.

This report explores what US consumers expect in 2025, why the AI threat era raises the stakes, and how mobile businesses can secure trust, retention, and growth by delivering protections without compromising the user experience.



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USA CONSUMER SURVEY

2025 Top Findings

Americans demand strong AI protections, fear fraud and identity theft above all, and treat security as the deciding factor between churn and loyalty.



1

High Demand, Low Trust in AI Protections

Nearly 9 in 10 US consumers (89.4%) demand protections against deepfakes, bots, and impersonation, outpacing global peers (85.9%). Yet confidence is fragile: only 10.6% feel "very confident" that their mobile apps are protected, while a third remain neutral and 15% openly doubt that these protections are in place. Despite strong demand, skepticism toward AI's role in fraud prevention highlights a widening gap between expectations and delivery.

2

Fraud Prevention and Privacy Protection Are Key

Fraud dominates US fears, with 63.7% citing synthetic fraud and 44.7% naming identity theft as the top reason for abandonment. At the same time, 23.0% of Americans refuse to use mobile apps without privacy protections, far above the global average (16.3%). This combination shows that fraud and privacy are the hard lines in the US, and mobile businesses that fail to meet both risk churn and declining ARPU.

3

Security Shapes Churn and Advocacy

A majority (54.2%) of Americans have abandoned mobile apps because of security concerns, and another 24.7% say "not yet," keeping churn risk high across the market. 24.4% of Americans are willing to recommend mobile apps privately, such as by word of mouth, but public advocacy lags with fewer users leaving reviews or posting on social media. This may encourage mobile brands to promote public advocacy of safe apps more actively, and step 1 is having a secure app.

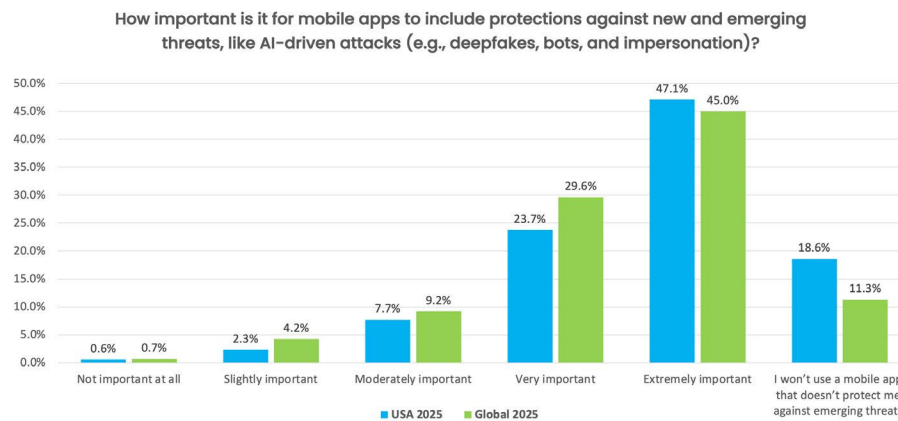
High Demand, Low Trust: The US AI Security Paradox

US consumers demand stronger protections against AI-driven threats than their global peers, yet they remain much less confident in app protections and skeptical of AI itself.



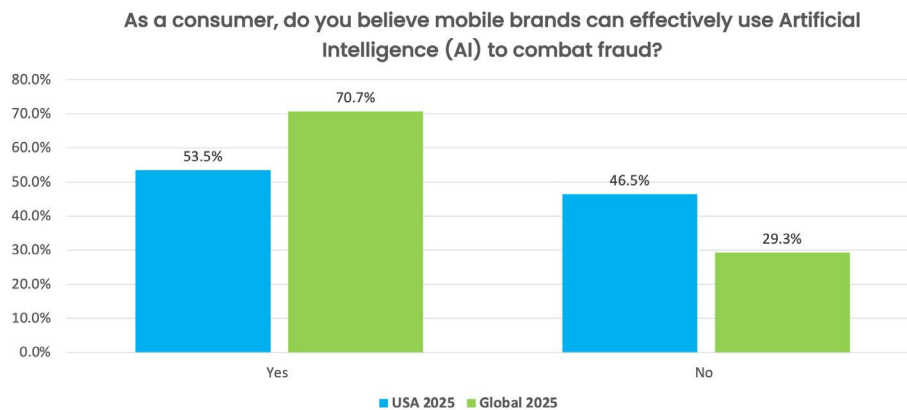
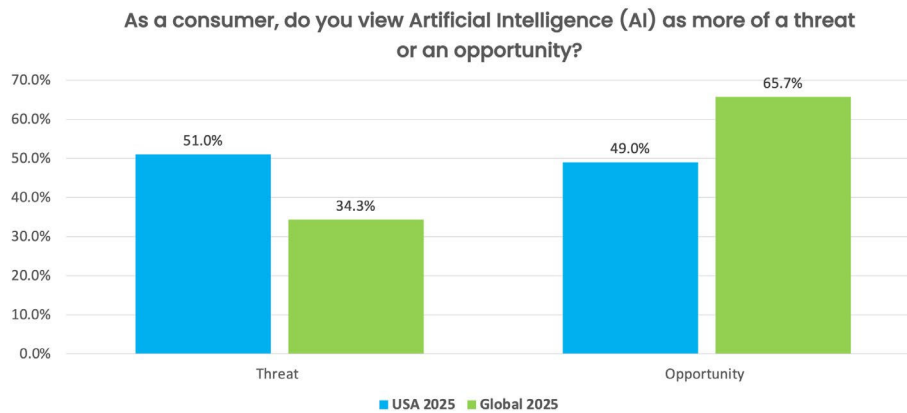
US Consumers Value Strong AI Protections

In the 2025 survey, 89.4% of US consumers say protections against AI-driven threats like deepfakes, bots, and impersonation are important, outpacing the global average (85.9%). Nearly one in five (18.6%) refuse to use mobile apps without these protections (64% higher than global peers), while 47.1% call them "extremely important". Together, these figures show that US consumers want to draw a clear line to only use protected apps, and mobile apps without protections against AI-driven threats will be rejected.



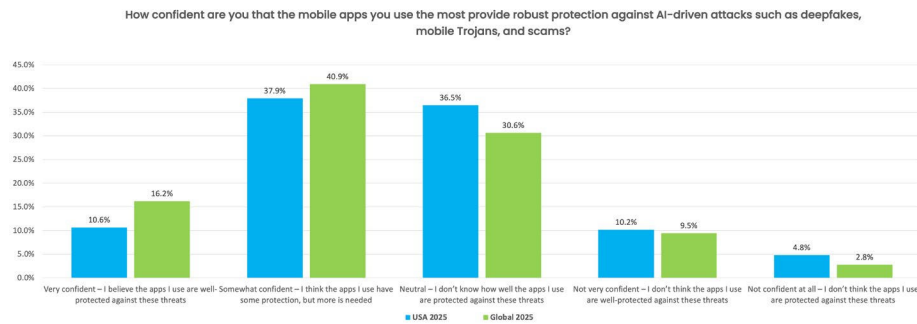
Skepticism About AI in Mobile Apps

A majority of US consumers (51%) see AI as a threat, nearly 49% higher than the global average. Just 53.5% believe mobile businesses can effectively utilize AI to combat fraud, which is far below the global average of 70.7%. This illustrates the paradox: Americans want AI protections but doubt mobile businesses can deliver them. This creates the opportunity for mobile businesses to deploy and carefully protect their consumers.



A Confidence Gap That Holds Back Trust

Confidence levels are strikingly low. Only 10.6% of US consumers feel "very confident" that their mobile apps provide robust protections against AI threats, far below the global average (16.2%). Over a third (36.5%) remain neutral, and 15% openly doubt that these protections are in place. Without government mandates or standards, the burden of AI protection falls squarely on mobile businesses.



In short

US consumers demand stronger AI protections than global peers but remain more skeptical of AI and less confident in mobile app protections. Mobile businesses need to move forward with their protection profiles and take on AI threats, and give consumers the knowledge that they are protected.

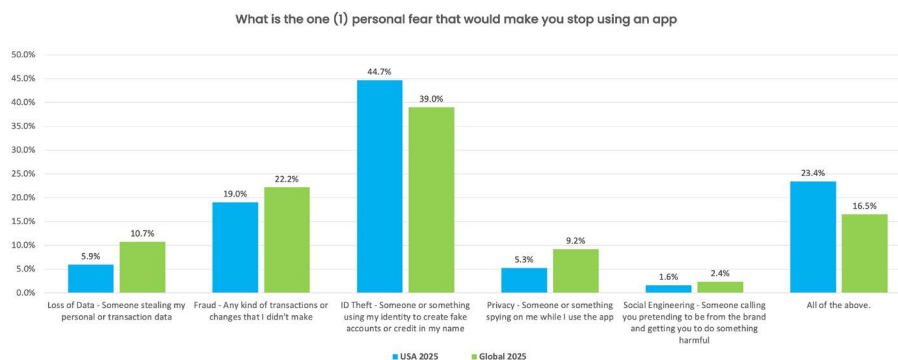
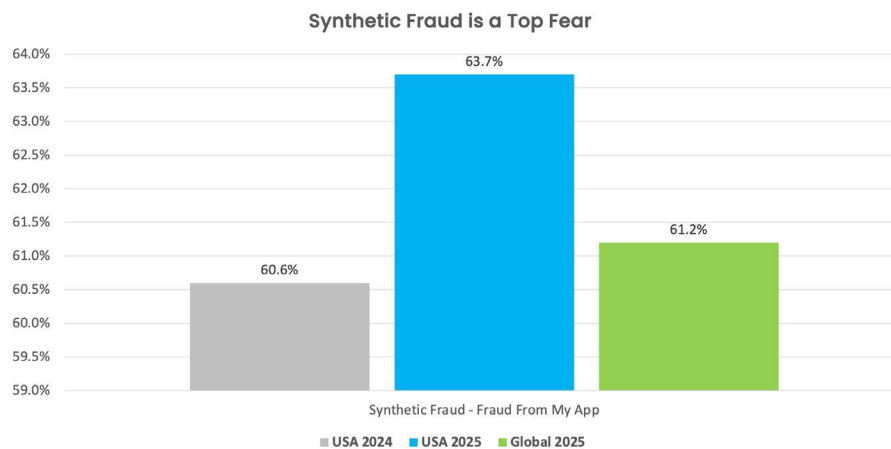
Synthetic Fraud Dominates, With Scams as Enablers

Fraud is the leading concern for US consumers, with identity theft driving abandonment and scams contributing to broader fraud risks.



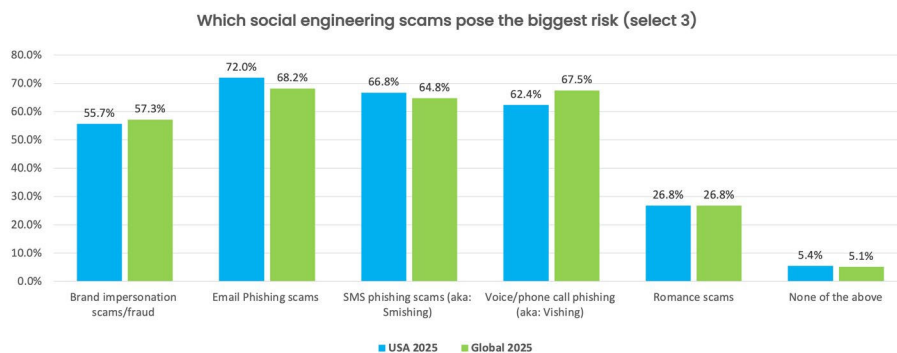
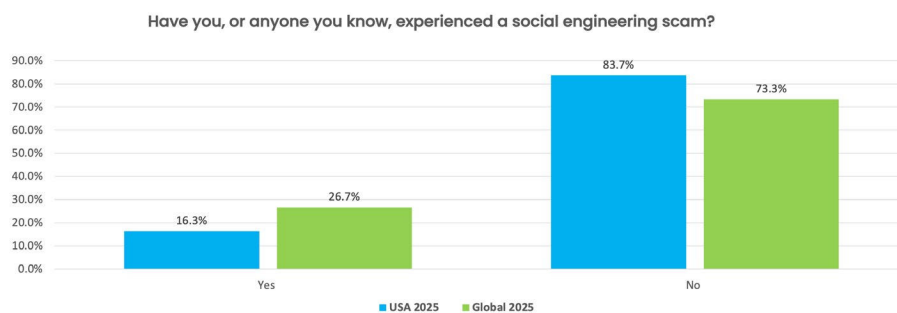
Fear of Fraud Compounds the Threat from AI

In 2025, 63.7% of US consumers cite synthetic fraud as their top fear, above both 2024 (60.6%) and global levels (61.2%). Identity theft is the leading cause of mobile app abandonment (44.7%), followed by all of the above (23.4%) and fraudulent transactions (19.0%). Over the last 5 years of this survey, this shows a shift, and a majority of the mobile app consumers, whose awareness, sophistication, and knowledge of the mobile app threatscape continues to increase annually.



Social Engineering Scams Are the Gateways to Fraud

The number of US consumers who have been exposed to social engineering attacks or know someone who has been the victim of such scams is lower in the US than globally (16.3% vs. 26.7%), but concern remains high. 72% cite email phishing as a top risk, followed by smishing (66.8%), vishing (62.4%), and brand impersonation (55.7%). These scams often serve as the entry point for identity theft and fraudulent transactions, making them an integral part of the broader fraud problem.



In short

Synthetic fraud is the top fear for US consumers. Additionally, 44.7% cite identity theft as the leading cause of abandonment. Scams amplify these risks, serving as gateways to fraud. Proactive prevention is the critical method mobile brands must embrace, not just stopping fraud after the fact.

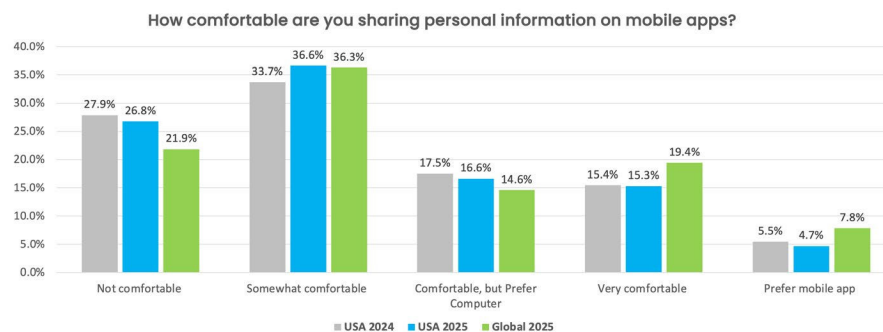
Privacy Matters and US Consumers Expect it by Default

Americans treat privacy as a non-negotiable expectation, but they rely heavily on "trust by default," forcing app makers to prove that their protections are in place.



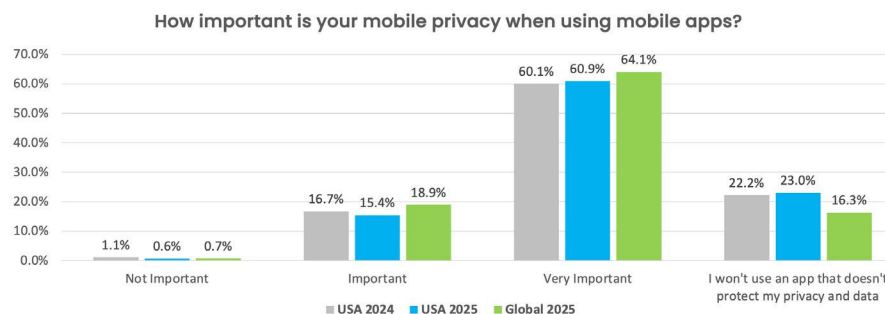
Caution When Sharing PII in Mobile Apps

In 2025, US consumers remain very cautious about sharing personal information in mobile apps. Over a quarter (26.8%) say they are "not comfortable", above the global average (21.9%). The largest group (36.6%) falls into the "somewhat comfortable" category, which is nearly identical to that of global peers. Only 20% describe themselves as "very comfortable" (15.3% vs. 19.4% globally) or prefer mobile outright (4.7% vs. 7.8% globally). This correlates with the high number of data breaches reported in the US.



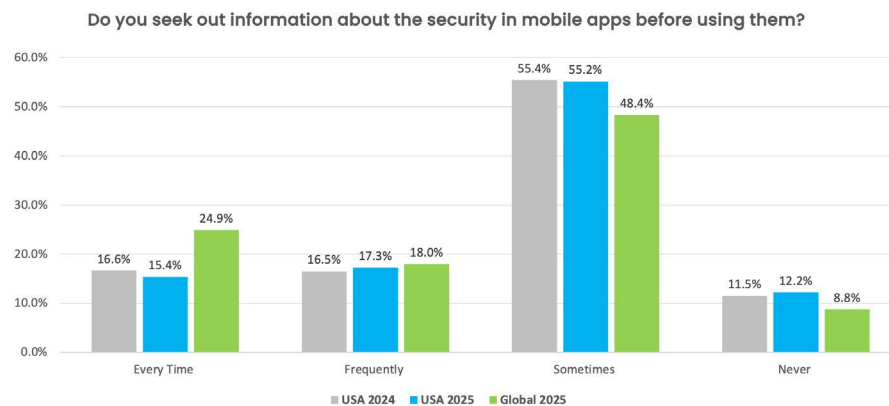
Privacy is Non-Negotiable for Americans

For US consumers, privacy is a baseline requirement, not an add-on. 60.9% say privacy is "very important" and 23.0% refuse to use mobile apps that fail to protect their data, a significantly higher percentage than the global average (16.3%). Compared to 2024, the results show stability in overall importance but a sharper edge in enforcement: Americans are increasingly willing to draw a hard line. Mobile businesses should take note: mobile apps without strong privacy protections will have a harder time gaining traction with US consumers.



Expectations vs. Reality in Privacy & Security

In this year's survey, as in years before, we asked US consumers how often they seek out information about security on the mobile apps they use before downloading them. Consistently, the percentages are small, with only 15.4% checking for mobile app security "every time", 55.2% checking "sometimes", and 12.2% never checking at all. Nonetheless, this is an opportunity for mobile businesses to take a standout, leadership position by promoting the security posture of their mobile apps on their websites, in email campaigns, and in release notes.



In short

Americans view privacy as non-negotiable, with 23% refusing unprotected mobile apps. Yet most rely on "trust by default," rarely checking protections themselves. Mobile businesses can also leverage marketing tactics like email and web site promotion to discuss app safety and protections to engender trust with their users.

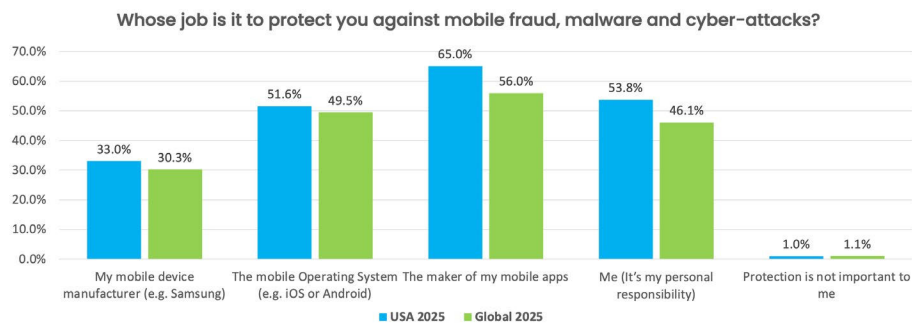
Responsibility for Security Lies with Mobile App Makers

Americans expect mobile app makers to take the lead on security, with prevention prioritized over reimbursement as the basis for trust.



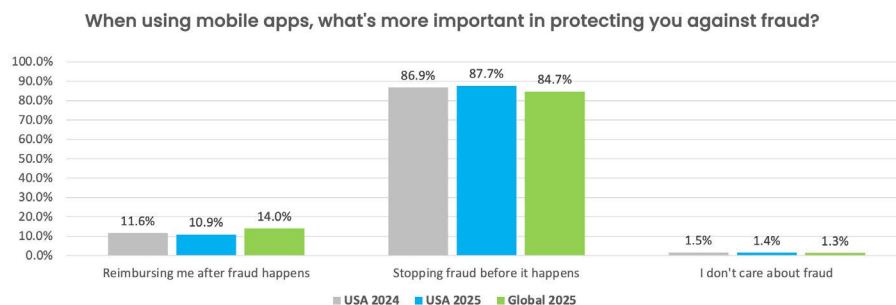
App Makers at the Center of Mobile Security

In 2025, 65.0% of US consumers say mobile app makers bear the most responsibility for protecting against fraud, malware, and attacks, far above the global average (56.0%). Responsibility assigned to mobile OS providers (51.6%) and device makers (33.0%) trails behind, reflecting the expectation that protections must be built directly into mobile apps. For US consumers, personal responsibility alone is not enough, and they view security as something that must be built into the mobile app by the app maker, as consumers are outgunned by the sophistication of today's threats and attacks to protect themselves.



Protection Drives Retention

Americans highlighted mobile fraud as one of their top concerns in this year's expectations survey. One of the biggest lingering questions is what the expectation is for how mobile businesses should handle fraud events – reactively or proactively. Again, the message is clear. 87.7% of US consumers prioritize preventing fraud before it occurs over reimbursement afterwards, which is higher than the global average of 84.7%. The lesson for mobile businesses is clear: proactive fraud prevention is essential to protect trust and reduce churn.





In short

US consumers hold mobile app makers responsible for protecting them against AI-driven threats. With 87.7% prioritizing fraud prevention over reimbursement, proactive fraud detection and prevention is essential for mobile app makers to retain trust and reduce churn.

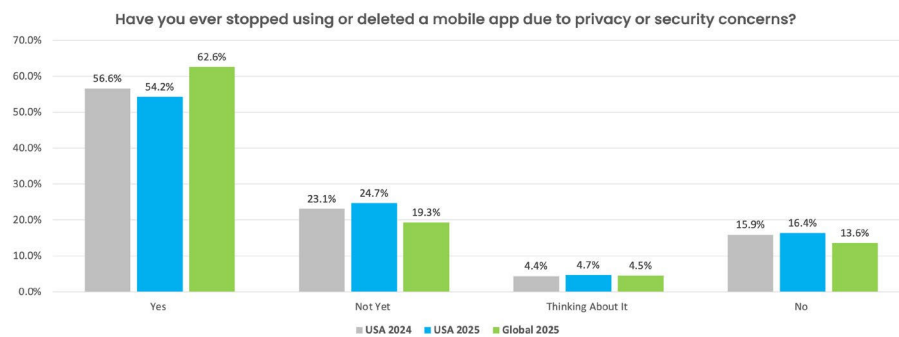
Security Is the Tipping Point Between Churn and Advocacy

Without protection, US consumers delete mobile apps quickly; with proven protections, they show loyalty, but advocacy remains muted.



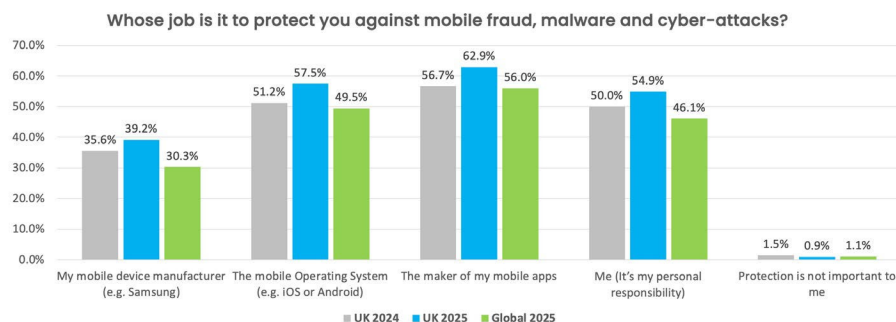
Privacy & Security Concerns = Churn

As security, privacy, and fraud risks increase, we were curious about how this could impact the mobile business itself. So, we asked US consumers if they had abandoned a mobile app due to a security or privacy issue. Consistent with the results of many years, more than half of the respondents said "yes", with this year's figure being 54.2%. This continues to be a cautionary tale for mobile businesses – without mobile app protections, mobile businesses risk user churn, reduced ARPU, and damage to their brand reputation.



Good Security Drives Advocacy

When protections are strong, security becomes a driver of loyalty. 24.4% of US consumers say they would privately recommend secure mobile apps, above the global average (20.2%). Visible advocacy is weaker: only 22.9% would post positive reviews (compared to 26.6% globally), and 21.2% would promote on social media (compared to 25.8% globally). The gap suggests that Americans reward mobile apps with their loyalty but are more restrained in openly endorsing them.





In short

In the US, weak security leads to churn, while strong security fuels loyalty. But unlike global peers, Americans are more reluctant to advocate publicly, leaving mobile businesses with a tougher job in turning secure users into vocal promoters.

7 Must-Know Truths About Mobile App Security

Other key findings in our 5th Annual Survey



Mobile leaves web in the dust

48.1% the majority of US consumers prefer mobile apps over web (29.7%).

Mobile app counts remain steady

82.4% of US consumers use between 3 and 20 mobile apps per week in 2025.

Security rivals features

92.3% of users now expect security to be a core product function, not an afterthought.

Consumers demand the best protection

56.2% of US consumers expect the strongest protection available.

US consumers are high users of social media & dating, mobile banking, and commerce

59.5% of US consumers report using social media, 44.5% mobile banking apps, and 41.8% use commerce apps the most.

All apps should have the highest security

62.8% of US consumers believe that any mobile app sharing PII data should prioritize the highest level of protection.

Developers don't care about security

29.1% of US consumers believe that developers do not care about their security.

Mobile-Dev & CISO Action Plan

AI-powered mobile app protection, built to defeat AI-driven attacks and meet the growing security expectations of mobile consumers. Your users expect protection. Here's how to deliver it.

The most effective way to counter AI-driven attacks and meet consumers' increasing security expectations is to combat AI with AI. Here's how to deliver it.



Strategic Shift

Shift priorities to mobile. Users live in apps, not browsers. Legacy defenses don't stop in-app fraud, malware, or AI-driven attacks. Invest in protection where it matters most.



Go Beyond Compliance

Obfuscation, RASP, encryption = table stakes. Get ahead of fraud by implementing in-app protections, API and bot device, and device binding, and using protections that match the needed workflows and use cases with your apps



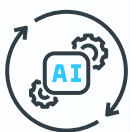
Automate

Build security into CI/CD from day one. Shift-left DevSecOps + AI = continuous, consistent protection. No SDKs. No manual coding. Real-time updates from live intel.



Threat Signals

See what's happening inside the app. Event-level telemetry detects fraud early and stops attacks in motion, without hurting UX.



Adapt

Fight AI with AI. Dynamic, conditional protections block evolving threats while preserving seamless user experiences.

The Appdome Advantage

Better Mobile App Protection, Faster & Easier than Everything Else

1 BUILD

AI-Native Mobile App Defense

Appdome's platform delivers in-app defense, API/bot protection, or customer identity protection directly in the mobile CI/CD pipeline. The DevOps class tool is connected to the mobile CI/CD pipeline. Choose in-app defense, API / bot protection, or customer identity protections for your mobile apps today.

2 PROTECT

Comprehensive Mobile App Protection

Choose from 400+ protections for any Android or iOS app, including anti-fraud, anti-malware, anti-bot, cheat prevention, ATOs, deepfakes, geo compliance, social engineering prevention, identity protection, code and data protection, and more. Start with a single feature and add more as you go. No code, no SDK, no servers, no agents required.

5 REMEDIATE

Threat Remediation Center™

Give your customer support organization the tools to help mobile end users understand, find and remove mobile malware, spyware and other threats on their Android and iOS devices with Appdome's Gen-AI powered Threat Remediation Agent™.

4 MONITOR

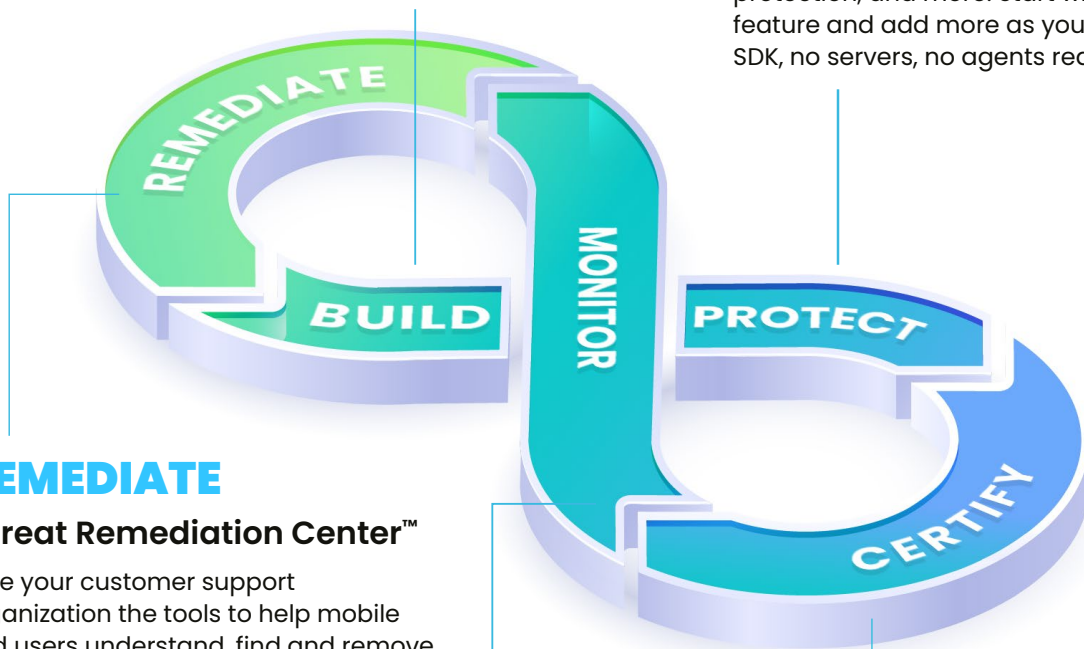
Mobile XTM Threat & Attack Intelligence

Utilize Appdome's ThreatScope Agentless Mobile XTM for real-time threat detection and attack monitoring to validate protection effectiveness, adapt defenses, and make your Android and iOS apps attack-aware.

3 CERTIFY

Certified Secure™

Appdome's Certified Secure™ is the only in-line security certification service ensuring protection for Android & iOS apps within the DevOps pipeline.



ABOUT APPDOME

Mobile App, API & Identity Protection in ONE

Appdome's mission is to protect every mobile business and user in the world from scams, fraud, bots, and attacks. Appdome's patented AI-Native XTM Platform is designed to protect every aspect of mobile business now and in the future. From mobile DevOps to mobile applications, networks, APIs, and Customer Identity, Appdome uses AI to generate Android & iOS defense plugins for 400+ mobile app security, anti-fraud, bot defense, anti-malware, geo compliance, social engineering, deepfake, and Customer Identity defenses on demand. Appdome also uses AI inside its ThreatScope™ Mobile XTM to continuously calculate a Mobile Risk Index™ for businesses and applications, as well as rank and preempt attacks in real-time. In Appdome's Threat Resolution Center™, Agentic-AI provides customer support and care teams a quick and easy way to provide end-user threat resolution and remediation. Appdome's Threat-Events™ framework gathers threat and attack metadata. It can be used to inform the application, application SDKs, and back-end network components when threats are present or to create customized threat responses inside Android & iOS apps. As a platform, Appdome functions as a continuous compliance center, tracking all builds, changes, teams, users, defense configurations, events, and more for quick and easy audit of the mobile defense lifecycle. Appdome holds several patents, including U.S. Patents 9,934,017 B2, 10,310,870 B2, 10,606,582 B2, 11,243,748 B2, and 11,294,663 B2. Additional patents pending.

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